

► VISOR ROSE

Although mainly utilitarian, some plate armour also bore decorative motifs, such as this rose, located on the hinge of the sallet helmet's visor.



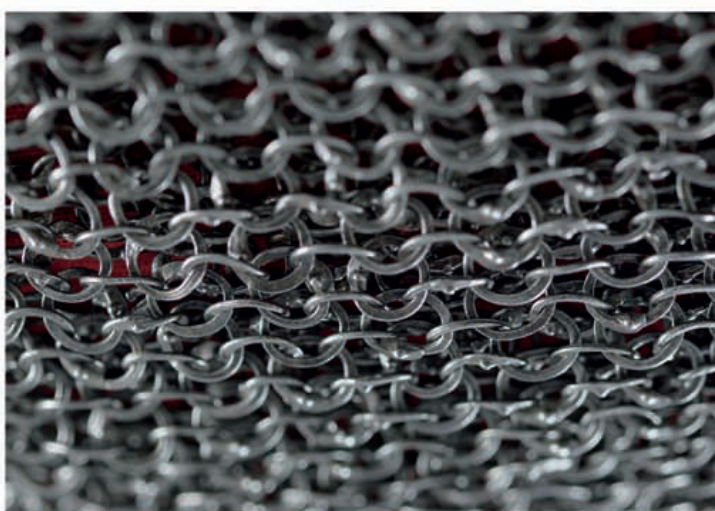
◄ BUCKLE

This buckle on the breastplate secured it to the back plate.



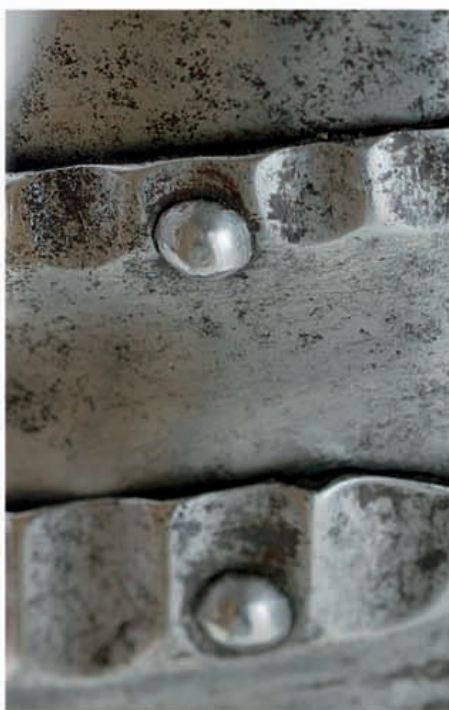
◄ MAIL

This protected exposed areas, such as the inner arms. Occasionally full mail hauberks were worn beneath the plate armour.



▼ CUISSE

Named after the French word for "thigh", this armour for the upper leg was designed to protect against blows both from forward-facing opponents, and upward strikes that might be dealt to the wearer when he was on horseback.



IN ACTION

ARMOUR IN BATTLE

Knights sometimes wore a combination of mail and plate armour, along with with a visored basinet, an aventail (mail collar), and a mail hauberk under a pair of plates covered with fabric. Despite the relatively high level of protection that plate armour offered its wearer, casualties were a regular occurrence, and mounted knights were particularly at risk from footsoldiers armed with staff weapons.



▲ The protection of full plate armour could count for little if a knight was unhorsed.